The Southwest

The Southwest region was spread out across several states including Texas, Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona and a strip of Mexico. The tribes that lived in this region were known as the Yuma, Yaqui, Zuni and the Hopi. Because of the somewhat fertile landscape, the natives were able to grow plants. Their homes were referred to as pueblos and were made from stone such that they reached several levels in height. It could be said that they were somewhat similar to a small, primitive apartment building. Within the heart of these communities, the natives built pit houses called the kivas. These were used for political meetings and for ceremonies related to religious rites.

Two of the most famous peoples from the Southwest region were the Apache and the Navajo. Unlike the others, they preferred a much more nomadic lifestyle. They survived by hunting and occasionally looting their neighboring communities. The Apache and the Navajo did not establish stable communities and homes like the Yuma. Instead, they created their rounded homes out of bark, mud and other simple materials. Their homes are known for always facing east.

Once the Mexican War came to an end, the Southwest region was incorporated into the United States. By this time, majority of the Native Americans in the area had been killed. The Spanish missionaries captured and made slaves from the Pueblo who quickly died from being overworked on vast estates created for the Spanish. Those who had survived the war were forced by the government to move to one of the Indian reserves.